SOPHOS

# XDR

A report by Pedapati Prem Kumar

**Introduction:** Sophos XDR (Extended Detection and Response) is a cybersecurity platform that unifies threat detection, investigation, and response across endpoints, servers, firewalls, email, and cloud environments. It helps organizations see bigger pictures of attacks and respond faster. It is a product developed by Sophos Limited, a British cybersecurity company founded in 1985 by Jan Hruska and Peter Lammer.

## Key Notes on Sophos XDR:

**Purpose:** Designed to protect against multi-stage, multi-vector attacks by correlating data across the IT ecosystem.

**Visibility:** Offers a single pane of glass view across endpoints, networks, servers, and cloud, helping analysts see the bigger picture.

**Threat Hunting:** Includes advanced tools and AI assistants to simply speed up investigations.

**Deployment Options:** Available as a full XDR suite or as an XDR Sensor that provides detection and investigation features alongside existing anti-malware tools.

**Efficiency:** Helps reduce noise, filter irrelevant alerts, and prioritize real threats, improving SOC and IT operations efficiency.

**Response Capabilities:** Enables remote investigation and remediation, including isolating endpoints, stopping processes, and cleaning up artifacts.

In short, Sophos XDR is a unified, AI-powered detection and response solution that strengthens security operations by correlating data across multiple sources, enabling faster and more accurate threat investigation and remediation. In today's rapidly evolving cyber threat landscape, tools such as Sophos XDR represent a critical advancement in security operations.

Traditional endpoint protection alone is no longer sufficient to counter sophisticated, multi-vector attacks. Sophos XDR extends detection and response capabilities across endpoints, servers, firewalls, email, and cloud environments, providing a unified view of the entire attack surface.

This holistic visibility enables security teams to correlate signals, identify hidden threats, and respond with precision.

Equally important is the integration capability of Sophos XDR. It can ingest data from third-party tools, making it adaptable to diverse environments and enhancing the overall security ecosystem. This flexibility ensures that organizations are not locked into a single vendor but can build layered defenses tailored to their needs.

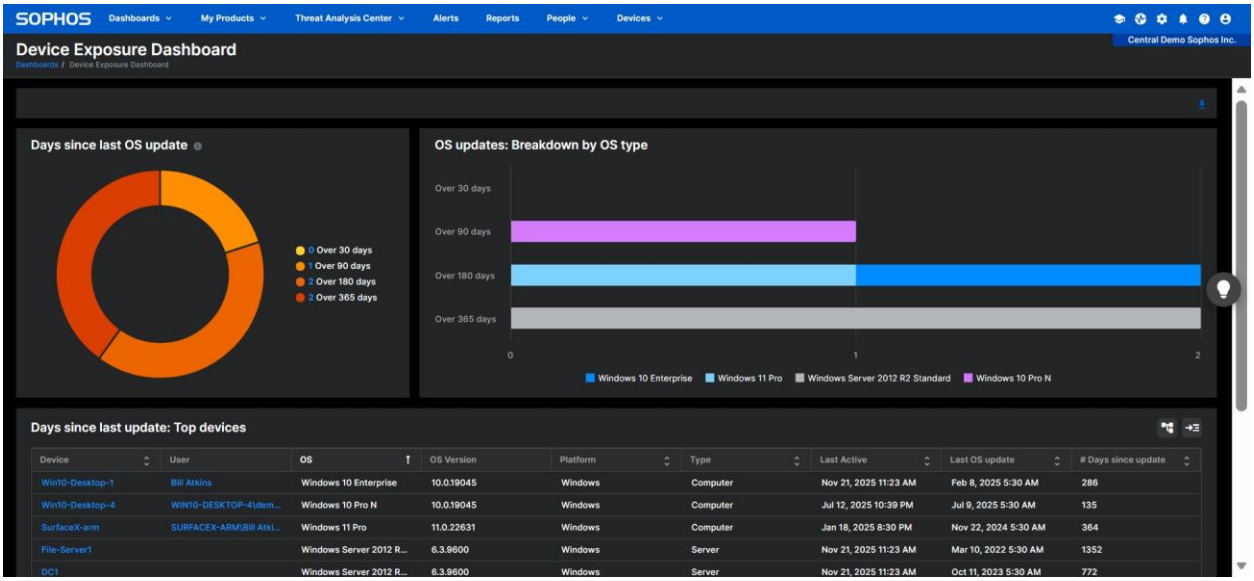
Ultimately, Sophos XDR and similar tools embody the shift toward proactive, intelligence-driven security. They empower both SOC teams and IT administrators to move from reactive firefighting to structured, evidence-based defense.

In doing so, they not only safeguard digital assets but also strengthen organizational confidence in the face of relentless cyber threats.

## Dashboards Of Sophos XDR:

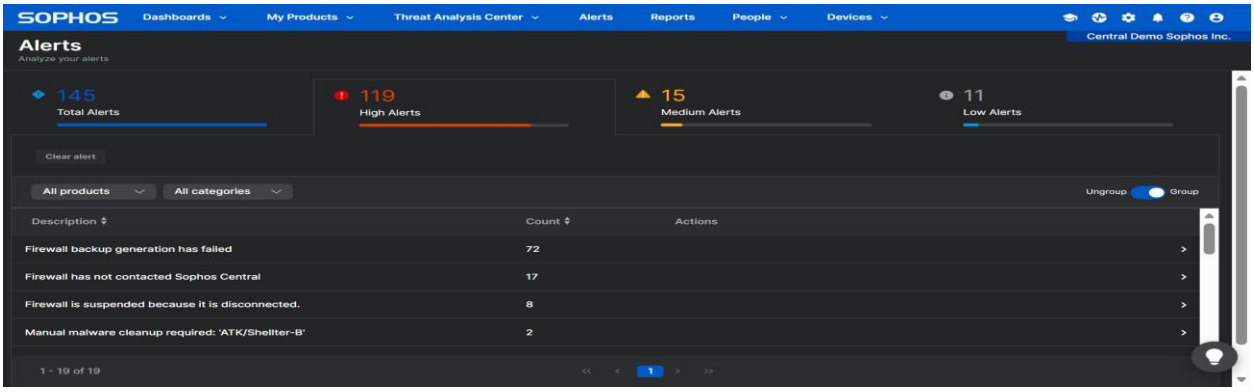
Dashboards in Sophos XDR provide centralized visibility, correlating data across endpoints, servers, firewalls, email, and cloud. They help analysts monitor threats, prioritize alerts, track investigations, and assess system health. By simplifying complex data into actionable insights, dashboards enable faster detection, streamlined response, and improved overall security operations efficiency.

### 1. Sophos Central Dashboard:



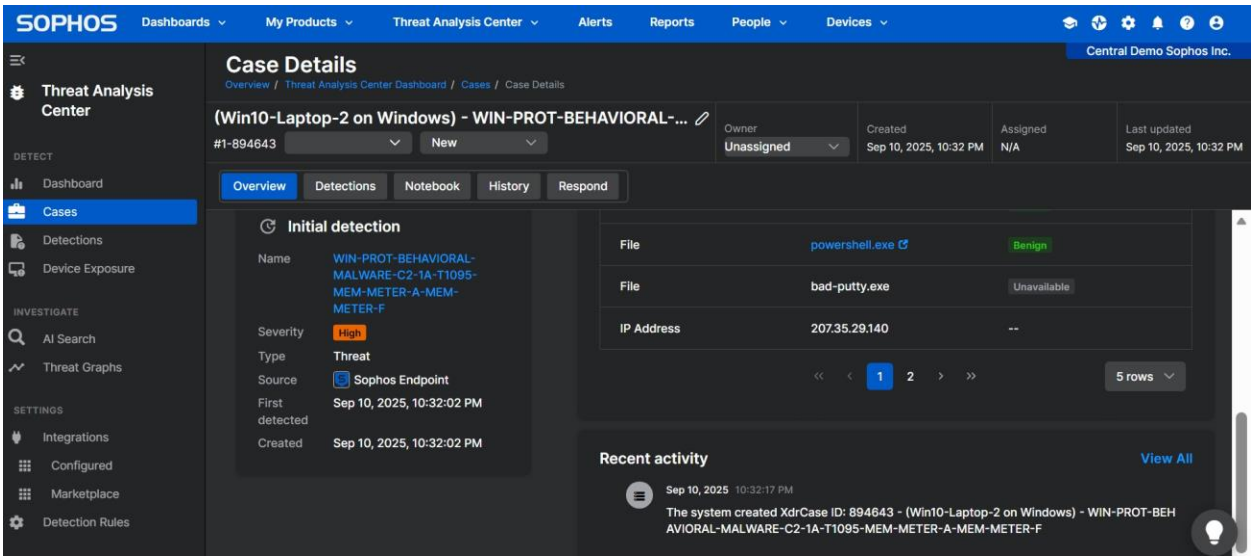

The Device Exposure Dashboard in Sophos Central visualizes OS update status across devices. It highlights five systems overdue by over 90 days, mainly running Windows 10 Enterprise. Charts and tables show update delays by OS type and device, helping administrators identify vulnerable endpoints and prioritize patching to reduce exposure risk.

### 2. Alerts:




The Sophos Central Alerts Dashboard displays 145 security alerts, with 119 marked as high severity. Key issues include failed firewall backups, disconnected firewalls, and manual malware cleanup needs. The interface categorizes alerts by severity and type, helping administrators prioritize remediation and maintain visibility across network security incidents.

### 3. Threat Analysis Center:

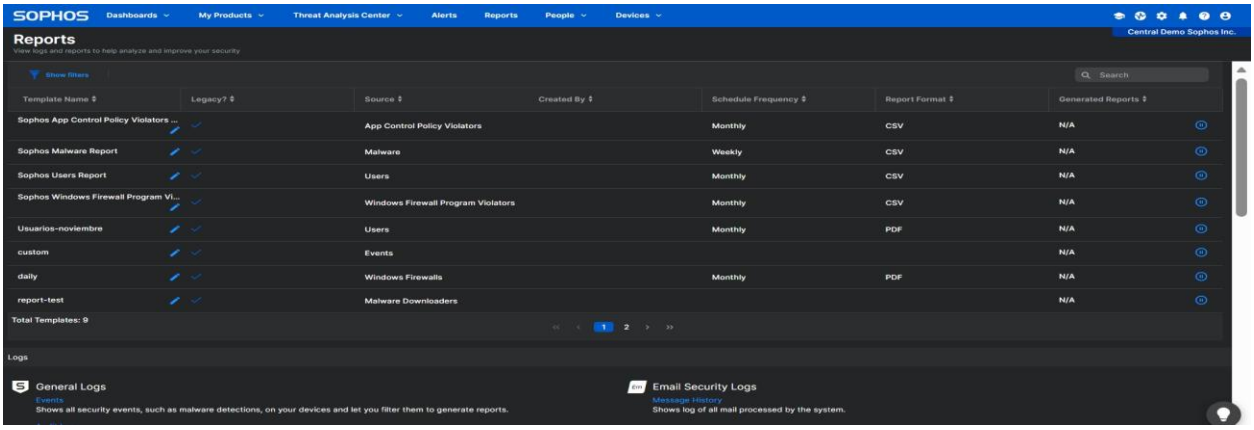



The Sophos Threat Analysis Center case details reveal a behavioral malware detection on a Windows 10 laptop.

The threat, linked to powershell.exe and bad-guyfile.exe, involves command-and-control activity (T1095) via memory-based HTA execution.

The case is unassigned, highlighting a need for investigation and response to potential endpoint compromises.

### 4. Reports and Logs:

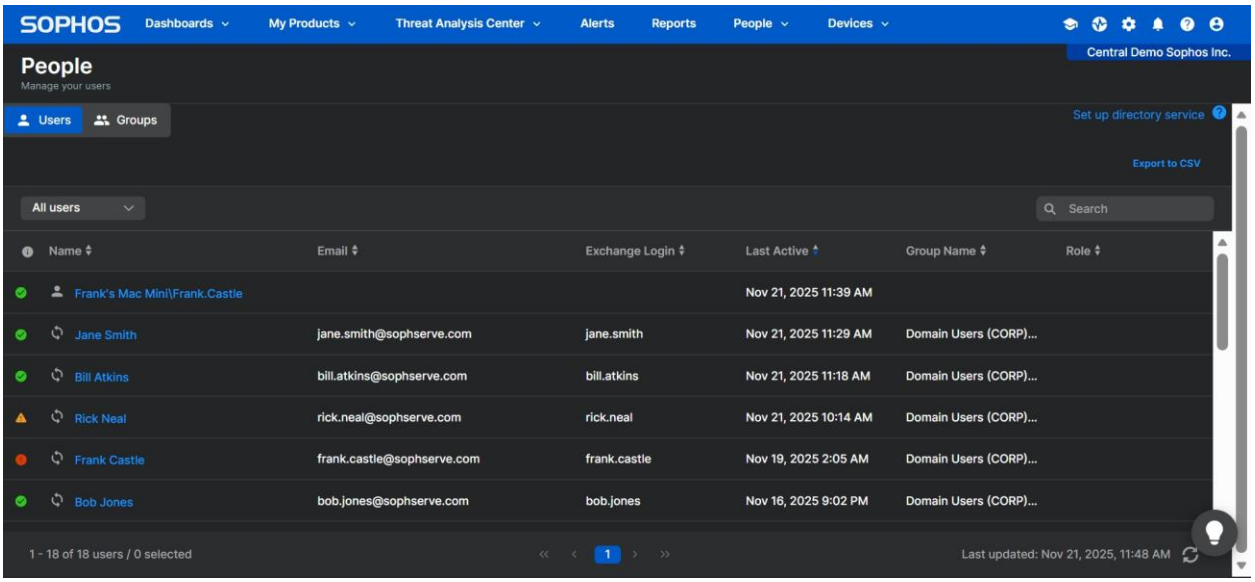



The Sophos Reports Dashboard displays scheduled report templates for monitoring security events like malware, firewall violations, and user activity.

Reports are generated in CSV or PDF formats on weekly or monthly schedules.

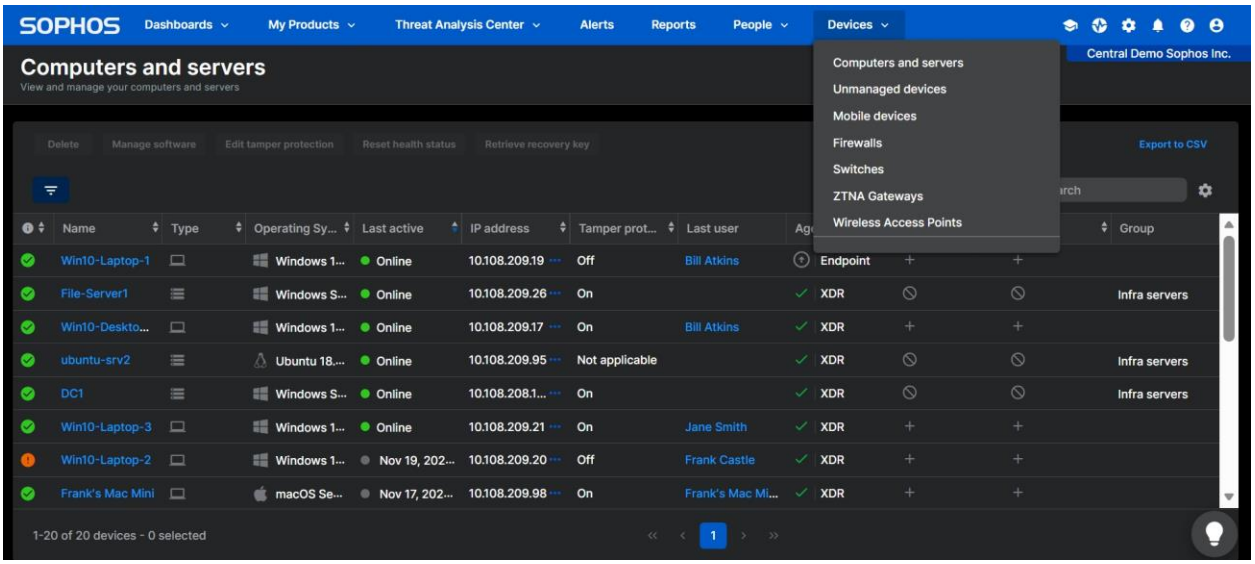
This centralized view helps administrators track policy compliance and threat trends across endpoints and network infrastructure.

**5. People:**



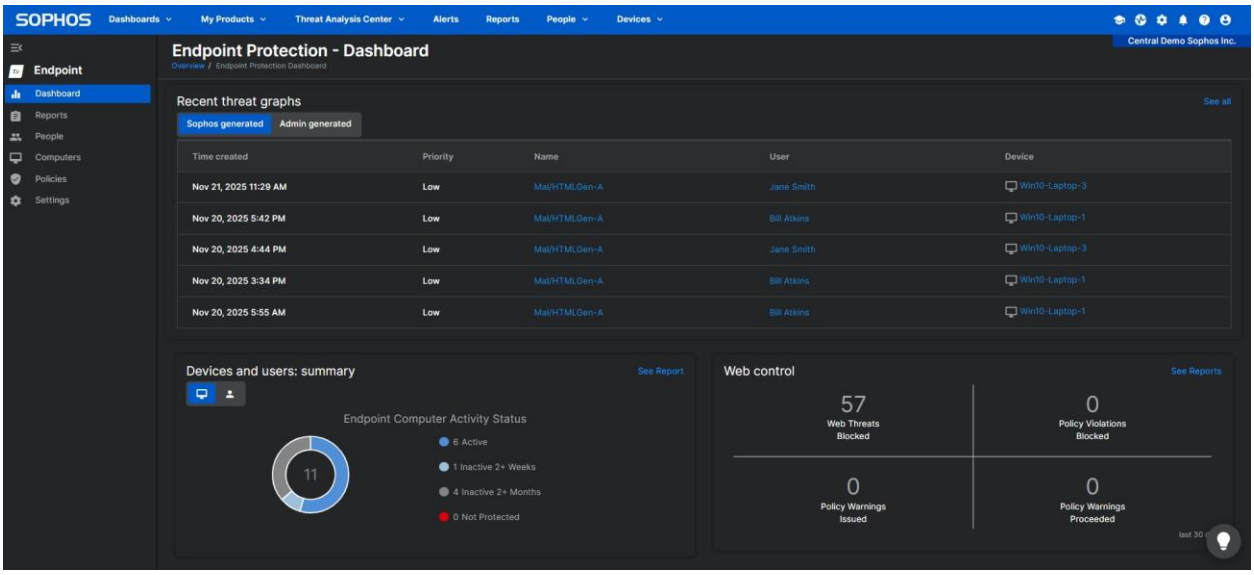

The Sophos Central People Dashboard helps administrators manage user identities, monitor activity, and assign roles. It displays user details like email, login, group membership, and last active time. Features include filtering groups, exporting to CSV, and integrating directory services for streamlined access control and audit readiness.

**6. Devices:**



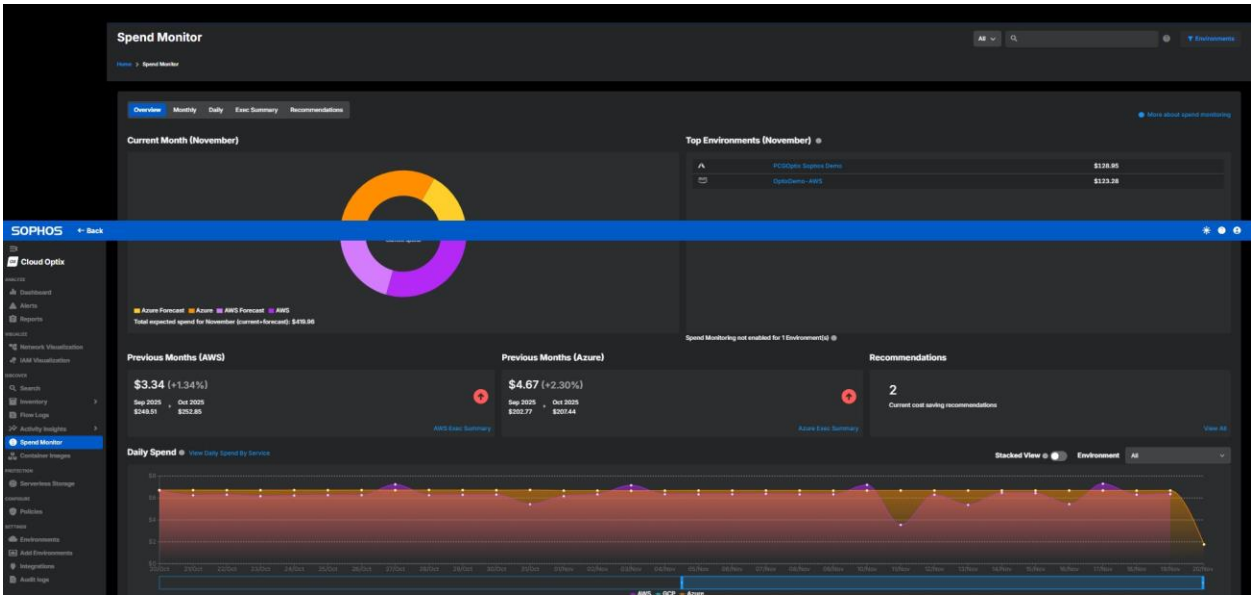

The Sophos Central "Computers and Servers" dashboard enables administrators to monitor device status, OS type, user association, and tamper protection. It supports endpoint grouping, real-time activity tracking, and centralized security management. This helps ensure compliance, detect inactive systems, and enforce protection policies across diverse operating systems and device types.

## 7. End-Point protection:




Sophos Endpoint Protection monitors threat activity, device status, and user interactions across the network. It identifies malware like Mal/HTMLGen-A, tracks active and inactive devices, and summarizes threat exposure. Web control metrics help enforce browsing policies, ensuring secure user behavior, and reducing risk from unblocked threats or policy violations.

## 8. Server Protection:

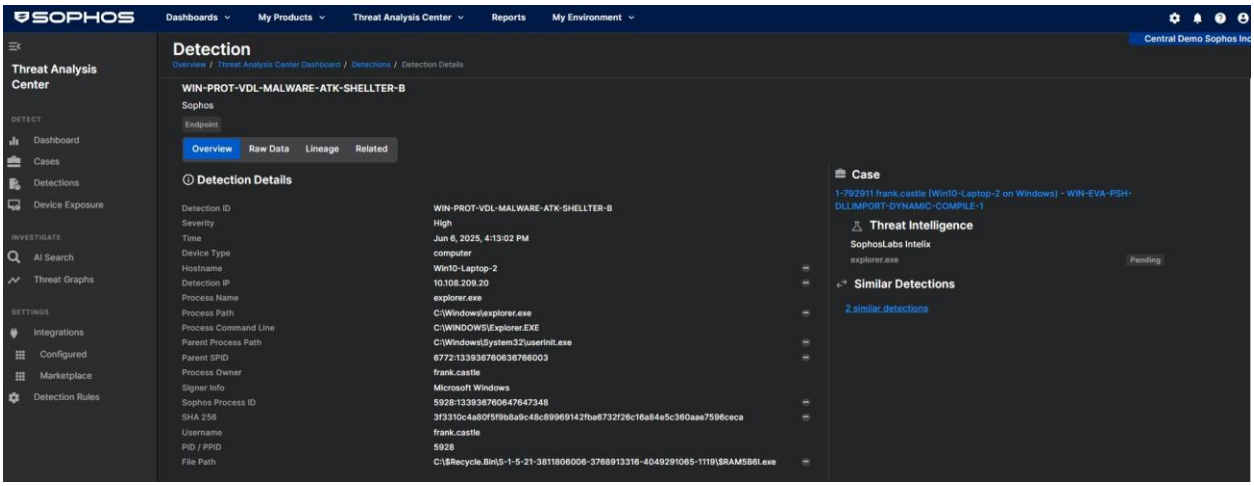



Sophos Spend Monitor tracks cloud expenses, forecasts monthly costs, and identifies top spending environments. It visualizes computing, storage, and other categories, offering recommendations to optimize usage and reduce unnecessary financial overhead.

# Example (use case):

## Detection ID: WIN-PROT-VDL-MALWARE-ATK-SHELLTER-B

## Overview:




1. Detection ID: WIN-PROT-VDL-MALWARE-ATK-SHELLTER-B

2. Severity: High

3. Time: Jun 6, 2025, 4:13:02 PM

4. Hostname: Win10-Laptop-2

5. Detection IP: 10.108.209.20

6. Process Name: explorer.exe

7. Process Path: C:\Windows\explorer.exe

8. Process Command Line: C:\WINDOWS\Explorer.EXE

9. Parent Process Path: C:\Windows\System32\userinit.exe

10. Parent SPID: 6772:133936760636766003

11. Process Owner: frank.castle

12. Signer Info: Microsoft Windows

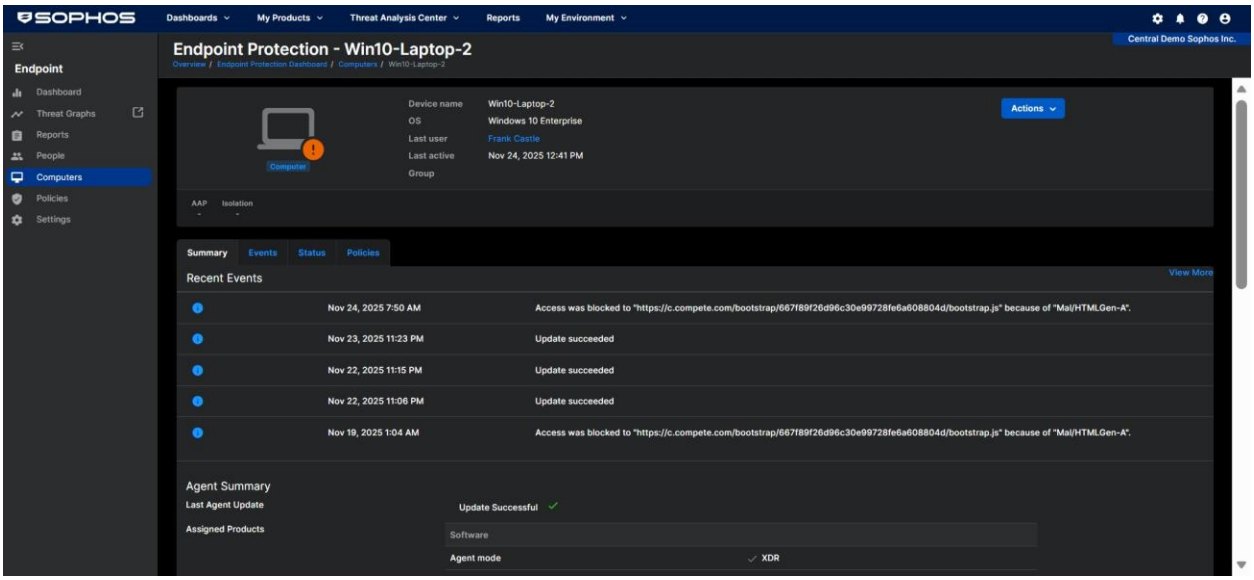
13. Sophos Process ID: 5928:133936760647647348

14. SHA 256: 3f3310c4a80f5f9b8a9c48c89969142fba6732f26c16a84e5c360aae7596ceca

15. Username/ Filepath : frank.castle/ C:\$Recycle.Bin\S-1-5-21-3811806006-3768913316-4049291065-1119\$RAM5B6I.exe

# Detailed report on 2 systems including their policy setup

## System 1:




## Summary:

1. Device Name**:** Win10-Laptop-2

2. Last user**:** Frank Castle

3. IPv4 Address**:** 10.108.209.20 and 192.168.66.21

4. IPv6 Address**:** fe80::80bf:fefd:c7ab:df1b

5. OS**:** Windows 10 Enterprise

6. Last Active**:** Nov 24, 2025 1:06 PM

## Recent Events:

| Time& Date | Events& Actions |
|---|---|
| Nov 24, 2025 7:50 AM | Access was blocked to "https://c.compete.com/bootstrap/667f89f26d96c30e99728fe6a608804d/bootstrap.js" because of "Mal/HTMLGen-A". |
| Nov 19, 2025 1:04 AM | Access was blocked to "https://c.compete.com/bootstrap/667f89f26d96c30e99728fe6a608804d/bootstrap.js" because of "Mal/HTMLGen-A". |
| Nov 18, 2025 2:43 PM | Access was blocked to "https://c.compete.com/bootstrap/667f89f26d96c30e99728fe6a608804d/bootstrap.js" because of "Mal/HTMLGen-A". |

## Agent Summary:

Update Status: Updated Succesfully

Agent Mode: XDR

Device Encryption: '+' Encryption module is present but may not be fully configured or active.

ZTNA: '+' Zero Trust Network Access is present, possibly pending configuration.

Core Agent: 2025.2.1.709.1 BETA

Sophos Intercept X: 2024.1.2.1.1 BETA

Process Architecture: x64

Groups: None

## Tamper Protection:

Tamper Protection: Off

(Sophos recommends that you turn on tamper protectionTamper protection ensures that users with local administrator rights can't uninstall Sophos Central Endpoint software or change settings.)

## Windows Firewall:

Status: Active (Domain, Private, Public)

Last Active Profiles: Domain

Windows Group Policy: None

Other firewalls: None

## Sophos Diagnostic Utility:

Status: Not Running

Last Run: 5 Years ago

File Name: 1ebae300-cef8-2456-7907-b49634e6f792_2020-06-19-11-30-56.zip

### Policies Applied to the System:

Policies below apply to Win10-Laptop-2.

| Type | Name |
|---|---|
| Encryption: Device Encryption | Encryption Disabled |
| Endpoint Protection: Application Control (user) | Base Policy - Application Control |
| Endpoint Protection: Data Loss Prevention (user) | Base Policy - Data Loss Prevention |
| Endpoint Protection: Windows Firewall (user) | Base Policy - Windows Firewall |
| Endpoint Protection: Peripheral Control (user) | Finance |
| Endpoint Protection: Threat Protection (user) | Base Policy - Threat Protection |
| Endpoint Protection: Update Management (user) | Base Policy - Update Management |
| Endpoint Protection: Web Control (user) | Sales |
| Endpoint Protection: Data Collection and Investigation (user) | Base Policy - Data Collection and Investigation |

**1. Device Encryption**: Status is "Encryption Disabled," indicating that data-at-rest protection is not active on this endpoint.

2. **Application Control:** Enforced via "Base Policy – Application Control," which restricts unauthorized or risky applications from executing.

3. **Data Loss Prevention (DLP):** Uses "Base Policy – Data Loss Prevention" to monitor and prevent sensitive data exfiltration by users.

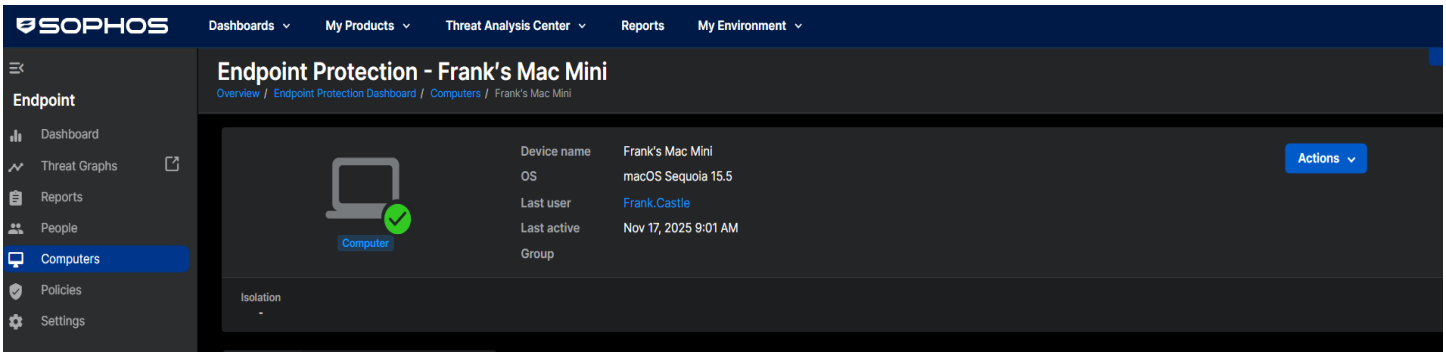
4. **Windows Firewall:** Enabled through the "Windows Firewall" policy, providing host-based network traffic filtering.

5. **Perimeter Control:** Assigned the "Finance" policy, likely tailored to restrict external device access or enforce network boundaries for financial users.

6. **Threat Protection:** Uses "Base Policy – Threat Protection" to detect and block malware, exploits, and behavioral threats.

7. **Data Collection & Investigation:** Uses "Base Policy – Data Collection and Investigation" to gather telemetry and support forensic analysis.

# System 2:




## Summary:

1. Device name: Frank′sMac Mini

2. Last user: Frank Castle

3. IPv4 Address: 10.108.209.98

4. IPv6 Address: fe80::82:df8:e9c0:b662

5. OS: macOS Sequoia 15.5

6. Last Active: Nov 17, 2025 9:01 AM

7. Group: None

## Recent Events:

| Date&Time | Events&Actions |
|---|---|
| Nov 20, 2025 8:06 AM | Scan 'Sophos Cloud Scheduled Scan' completed. |
| Nov 8, 2025 6:40 AM | A macOS device doesn't meet Sophos prerequisites and might not be protected. |

## Agent Summary:

1. Agent Version: 2025.2.0.96

2. Update Status: Updated Successfully

3. Agent Mode: XDR

4. Device Encryption: '+' Encryption module is present but may not be fully configured or active.

5. ZTNA: '+' Zero Trust Network Access is present, possibly pending configuration.

6. Core Agent: 2025.2.0.96

7. Group: None

8. Processor architecture: arm64

## Tamper Protection:

Tamper Protection: On

## Sophos Diagnostic Utility:

Status: Not Running

Last Run: Never

## Policies Applied to this System:

Policies below apply to Frank's Mac Mini.

| Type | Name |
| --- | --- |
| Encryption: Device Encryption | Base Policy - Device Encryption |
| Endpoint Protection: Application Control (user) | Base Policy - Application Control |
| Endpoint Protection: Data Loss Prevention (user) | Base Policy - Data Loss Prevention |
| Endpoint Protection: Windows Firewall (user) | Base Policy - Windows Firewall |
| Endpoint Protection: Peripheral Control (user) | Base Policy - Peripheral Control |
| Endpoint Protection: Threat Protection (user) | Base Policy - Threat Protection |
| Endpoint Protection: Update Management (user) | Base Policy - Update Management |
| Endpoint Protection: Web Control (user) | Base Policy - Web Control |
| Endpoint Protection: Data Collection and Investigation (user) | Base Policy - Data Collection and Investigation |

These are the policies that are applied to Frank's Mac Mini..

**1. Device Encryption**: Status is "Encryption Disabled," indicating that data-at-rest protection is not active on this endpoint.

2. **Application Control:** Enforced via "Base Policy – Application Control," which restricts unauthorized or risky applications from executing.

3. **Data Loss Prevention (DLP):** Uses "Base Policy – Data Loss Prevention" to monitor and prevent sensitive data exfiltration by users.

4. **Windows Firewall:** Enabled through the "Windows Firewall" policy, providing host-based network traffic filtering.

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